

THE J FORMULA

SHADES EQ FORMULA GUIDE

12 Professional Formulas + Complete Tone Reference

by Janine Fernandez • 15 Years Behind the Chair

Color Theory Based • Salon Tested • Dimension Focused

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UNDERSTANDING THE THREE BACKGROUNDS

Every Shades EQ shade has a background foundation. Understanding this is key to formulating.

BLACK TO GRAY

Cool foundation that diminishes warmth. Cancels orange and yellow.

T, N, NA, V, VB, M, GI, G

BROWN TO TAN

Balanced, natural foundation. Great for gray coverage. Enhances warmth.

NB, NW, WG, GG, P, CB, RB, GRo

NO BACKGROUND

Most vibrant, true-to-tone results. Pure reflect with no dilution.

AA, C, CC, R, RV, VV, VG, VRo

KEY PRINCIPLE

To neutralize unwanted tone, use its opposite: Violet cancels Yellow, Blue cancels Orange, Green cancels Red.

COLOR THEORY FORMULAS

Creamy Vanilla Platinum

Cool-leaning cream blonde with body that never reads grey

MELT: **7NB + 8VB (equal parts)**

ENDS: **10WG + 10GI + Clear (equal parts)**

The melt uses NB's red-violet undertone to add warmth and depth at level 7 while VB introduces blue-green to fight orange. At the ends, 10WG pushes vanilla warmth with its yellow-orange base, 10GI's blue-gold iridescence adds champagne dimension, and Clear sheers it out to prevent over-deposit.

Toasted Honey Bronde

Multi-tonal warm blonde that shifts in different light

MELT: **6N + 7NB (2:1)**

ENDS: **9WG + 9GI + 9P (equal parts)**

6N is the neutral anchor with its blue undertone. 7NB adds red-violet warmth to the shadow zone. Three different expressions layer at the ends — 9WG reads buttery (yellow-orange), 9GI brings champagne beige (blue-gold iridescence), 9P's gold-violet balance adds luminosity.

Smoky Mushroom Melt

Moody, editorial cool with alive dimension

MELT: **5N + 6M (equal parts)**

ENDS: **8T + 8NA + 8GI (2:1:½)**

5N gives true mid-depth neutral with its blue base. 6M's blue-mahogany undertone creates earthy, muted tones without going ashy. The ends use 8T titanium (silver-blue, the coolest in the line) for steel-silver smoke, 8NA's blue-violet cancels brass, and 8GI keeps the mushroom alive with dimensional blue-gold iridescence.

Iced Espresso Brunette

Cool, expensive brunette — cold brew, not hot chocolate

MELT: **4N + 5NB (equal parts)**

ENDS: **7NA + 7M + 7NB (2:1:1)**

4N builds rich dark-chocolate base with its blue undertone. 7NA leads with blue-violet to cancel both orange and yellow. 7M's blue-mahogany neutralizes red without going ashy, 7NB's red-violet balances for natural-looking depth.

Rose Gold Champagne

Blush champagne that reads 'Is that her natural color?'

MELT: **6NB + 7RB (2:1)**

ENDS: **9RB + 9P + 9GI (equal parts)**

NB's red-violet creates warm foundation. 7RB weaves in red-brown for warm mauve shadow. At the ends, 9RB delivers soft rose-copper (red-brown undertone), 9P's gold-violet creates luminous cool warmth, 9GI's blue-gold transforms it into champagne territory.

Sun-Drenched Bronze

Liquid bronze that catches light like metal

MELT: **5NB + 6CB (equal parts)**

ENDS: **8C + 8WG + 8GG (2:1:1)**

NB's red-violet undertone creates dimension against warm ends. 8C (pure copper, no background) deposits vibrant orange. 8WG's yellow-orange pushes toward honey-butter. 8GG's pure gold on brown-to-tan background softens the whole thing into wearable bronze.

'& JANINE'S SIGNATURES '&

SIGNATURE FORMULAS

Gunmetal Ash

Deliberately smoked shadow root melting into clean, airy blonde

BASE: **6N + 6T**

ENDS: **8NA + 9GI**

Titanium at level 6 is silver-blue — the coolest series in the entire line. Creates graphite-to-platinum gradient. 8NA's blue-violet cancels brass at the transition. 9GI's blue-gold iridescence keeps ends luminous, not flat.

Golden Hour Velvet

Rich warm blonde with violet sophistication underneath

BASE: **7NB + 7GG**

ENDS: **8VG + 9GI + 8WG**

NB's red-violet undertone creates depth. GG is pure gold on brown-tan background. 8VG is the star — violet-gold with no background creates multi-dimensional warmth that separates it from basic brass. GI's blue-gold keeps it champagne.

Violet Frost

Editorial mahogany shadow dissolving into lavender-platinum

BASE: **7M + 8NA**

ENDS: **10P + 10T + 10NB**

7M's blue-mahogany creates plummy, wine-stained shadow. 8NA bridges with blue-violet. The ends are pure ice: P's gold-violet sheers the deposit, T's silver-blue adds steel, NB's red-violet keeps it from going grey. The contrast is editorial.

Soft Platinum

Your-hair-but-platinum — wearable, not severe

BASE: **7NB + 6N**

ENDS: **10NB + 9NW + 10P**

The secret is 9NW: Natural Warm has gold undertone on brown-tan background — that whisper of warmth makes platinum wearable versus severe. Pure cool at level 10 can read grey; NW softens without going brassy. NB's red-violet keeps yellow eliminated.

Espresso Silk

Brunette sorcery — single-level dimension that makes brown look expensive

BASE: **5N + 5NB**

ENDS: **5NW + 6NB + 6GI**

This is how you make brown hair look expensive. N's blue undertone plays against NB's red-violet. NW's gold adds warmth, GI's blue-gold iridescence adds reflectivity. Tonal shift without level change — light bouncing between cool and warm creates internal dimension.

Amethyst Frost

Fashion-forward lavender-platinum without fully committing

BASE: **9M + 7N**

ENDS: **10VV + 10N + 10P**

10VV is double violet with NO background — pure violet pigment for true lavender-lilac at level 10. Heavy-hitting yellow cancellation. 10N's blue undertone grounds it, 10P's gold-violet sheers it out. For the client who wants purple-platinum without full fashion commitment.

SHADES EQ TONE REFERENCE

'Dp COOL SERIES — Black to Gray Background

T Titanium

Silver / Blue

Coollest in the line. Icy silver.

N Natural

Blue

Cool neutral. Tones yellow.

NA Natural Ash

Blue / Violet

Cancels orange AND yellow.

V Violet

Blue / Violet

Cancels yellow. Watch for green on orange.

G Gold

Green / Yellow

GREEN-gold, not warm gold!

VB Violet Blue

Blue / Green

Cool blonde. Can go green on yellow.

M Matte

Blue / Mahogany

Neutralizes red without ash.

GI Gold Iridescent

Blue / Gold

Champagne beige. Blonde favorite.

G Gold

Green / Yellow

GREEN-gold, not warm gold!

WARM SERIES — Brown to Tan Background

NB Neutral Brown

Red / Violet

TRUE natural. Must use for gray coverage.

NW Natural Warm

Gold

Warmth with restraint.

WG Warm Gold

Yellow / Orange

Perfect for tinting back to brown.

GG Gold Gold

Gold (Pure)

Intense warmth. Double gold.

P Pearl

Gold / Violet

Luminous. Never goes flat.

CB Copper Brown

Red / Orange

Rustic red-brown.

RB Red Brown

Red / Brown

Rose, cinnamon, mauve.

GRo Gold Rosé

Gold / Rosé

Rose-gold blonde.

Ø=Ü¥ VIBRANT SERIES — No Background

AA Double Copper

Orange / Orange
Vibrant copper. NOT ash!

C Copper

Orange
Pure copper. Bright.

CC Copper Copper

Orange / Red
Intensely pigmented copper-red.

R Red

Red
Pure red. Very vibrant.

RV Red Violet

Red / Violet
Plum and berry tones.

VV Violet Violet

Violet
Heavy-hitting violet. Lavender toner.

VG Violet Gold

Violet / Gold
Multi-dimensional beige.

VRO Violet Rosé

Violet / Rosé
Soft rosy-violet.

Ø=Ýúþ QUICK CANCELLATION REFERENCE

- Violet cancels Yellow
- Blue/Violet cancels Yellow-Orange
- Blue cancels Orange
- Blue/Green cancels Red-Orange
- Green cancels Red
- Red/Violet cancels Yellow-Green

THANK YOU

Questions? DM me @colorbyjanine

thejformula.com

